

Board: 1

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

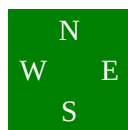
Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board 1
West Deals
None Vul

♠ J 9 8 4
♥ Q 10 3
♦ K 9 2
♣ 9 6 3

♠ K 7 3
♥ A 6 4
♦ Q J 10 5
♣ A 8 2



♠ 10 5 2
♥ J 9 8
♦ 6 4
♣ K Q J 10 4

♠ A Q 6
♥ K 7 5 2
♦ A 8 7 3
♣ 7 5

West	North	East	South
Pass	1♦	Pass	1♥
Pass	1NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North
West has the ♦K you can still make 2 winners.

The problem is that if you win the first or second ♣ and then try the ♦ finesse West may win and still have a ♣ to lead back to his partner. So you should hold up the ♣A until the third round of the suit. Then if West wins the ♦K he may not have another ♣.

Imagine that you had won either the first or second ♣. When West won the ♦K he would still have had a ♣ to return to East's hand. You would have lost 4 ♣ tricks and the ♦K.

But what if West **DID** have another ♣ when he won the ♦K?

Suppose you held up until the third ♣. When West won the ♦K here he had a fourth ♣ to return to East's hand. That means the ♣ suit split 4-4 so you would have lost only 3 ♣ tricks and the ♦K.

With 14 points you will naturally open the bidding. You should open a 4-card ♦ suit rather than a 3-card ♣ suit. Partner responds 1♥.

Partner might have bid a 4-card suit so you cannot support ♥s with only 3. Instead, you describe your balanced, minimum opener by bidding 1NT. Partner then bids 3NT and you pass.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♣K.

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Winners: ♠ 3 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 7

You need to find 2 more winners and they can come from the ♦ suit. You can finesse East for the ♦K. If he has it then you will get 3 extra tricks, but even if

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 7 2
 ♥ K Q 8 6
 ♦ Q 9 2
 ♣ K Q 7

♠ 10

♥ 10 9 7 4 2

♦ 7 3

♣ 10 9 5 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A K 8 6 5 4

♥ J

♦ 8 6

♣ A J 8 3

♠ J 9 3

♥ A 5 3

♦ A K J 10 5 4

♣ 6

West

North

East

South

3 ♦

Pass

1 ♠

2 ♦

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

East plays 4 ♠. South leads the ♦ A, then ♦ K, then ♦ J. North discards on the second ♦ and ruffs the third one with the ♠ T.

Losers: ♠ 0? : ♥ 1 : ♦ 2? : ♣ 0 : Total = 3?

The loser count looks a little messy - that's because of the circumstances. If you could have just played three rounds of ♠s you would probably have had 0 losers, and if you ruff this ♦ you will have only 2 ♦ losers, but maybe create a ♠ loser.

But though the loser count is confused your plan should not be. You **DO NOT** over-ruff the ♠ 10. Instead you discard your one ♥ loser (a loser-on-loser play). North can have this trick but whatever he returns you will win, pull trumps in **THREE** rounds if necessary, and take the rest of the tricks.

Discarding the ♥ loser instead of over-ruffing was the winning Plan. If you had over-ruffed you would have lost the ♥, but you would also have to lose a trump. You made a good play.

But did you notice that South made a bad play? He should have cashed his ♥ A before he led the third ♦ for his partner to ruff. Then when his partner ruffed with the ♠ 10 your goose would have been cooked.

You have an easy 1 ♠ opening bid.

But South overcalls 2 ♦ and partner bids 3 ♦.

You should be certain to have a partnership agreement on the meaning of a cue-bid after an overcall.

Most good players use it to show support for opener's suit and at least 11 points. In other words, a hand with which you would have made a limit-raise or better.

So you bid the ♠ game.

East plays 4 ♠. South leads the ♦ A, then ♦ K, then ♦ J. North discards on the second ♦ and ruffs the third one with the ♠ 10.